

Mercedes D. Edwards

AI GOVERNANCE PROFESSIONAL | AI ENABLEMENT THROUGH GOVERNANCE, PROCESS & BUSINESS ARCHITECTURE

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Authorized to work: U.S. & U.K.

PROFILE

AI governance and business architecture professional with a proven track record of identifying systemic process and governance gaps, operationalizing compliance-focused workflows spanning Sales, Finance, Operations, and Technology teams across international organizations. Background in business analysis, process optimization, value mapping, and AI enablement and governance provides a strong foundation for steering enterprise-wide AI adoption that adheres to risk-profile and compliance. Specialized in identifying AI use cases aligned with business and growth objectives, managing stakeholders and champion teams throughout technology adoption, creating technical education and training when the need is identified, and translating regulatory requirements into enforceable system controls. Committed to responsible AI adoption as a force for real social good.

EXPERIENCE

BRND United

Jul 2025 – Present | Remote

Founder & Principal Consultant

- Technology and AI consulting practice advising small business clients on operational process improvement, AI integration, and governance-aware workflow automation.
- Delivered 9 AI adoption engagements for small business clients — designing governance-aware workflows with data flow mapping, access controls, and process logic documentation ensuring traceability and auditability
 - Developed AI governance guidelines for non-technical clients adopting generative AI tools, covering acceptable use, data handling, and output quality controls
 - Building applied AI governance portfolio through scenario-based projects spanning healthcare, manufacturing, and luxury retail — producing controls matrices, risk registers, model documentation, and evidence architecture designs aligned to ISO 42001, NIST AI RMF, EU AI Act, and ISO 27001
 - Developing a nonprofit initiative focused on technology access and community empowerment, with plans to launch in 2027 — extending governance-aware AI adoption beyond enterprise clients to underserved communities

The Process Play

May 2023 – Sep 2024 | London, U.K.

Consultant — Business Analysis & Process Governance

- Client-facing consultant delivering enterprise digital transformation projects with a focus on process governance, requirements traceability, and compliance-aware system design across supply chain operations, HR service delivery, and IT service management.
- Managed a tri-party enablement partnership between ServiceNow, Northeastern University London, and The Process Play — establishing program governance and curriculum standards for a national technology education initiative, delivering 2 cohorts to 15+ participants
 - Served as fractional IT department for a mid-market client, facilitating governance-focused workshops across all departments with 6 key stakeholders steering the engagement
 - Mapped and optimized 8 key business processes for automation, producing traceable requirements documentation with clear lineage from regulatory and policy sources through to implemented controls
 - Identified governance gaps in data handling, access controls, and audit trail coverage across fragmented workflows between legacy ERP systems and cloud platforms

LHH ICEO

Apr 2020 – Mar 2021 | London, U.K.

Operations Manager | VP, Diversity & Inclusion Committee

Led operations and cross-functional governance for a national career transition and executive coaching practice spanning 50+ team members across the UK and Ireland. Owned governance framework design, compliance oversight, and process improvement initiatives.

- Identified systemic governance failures across the commercial lifecycle — missing contracts, inconsistent terms, absence of financial oversight — and designed a tiered commercial governance framework with digital contract workflows, cross-functional approval processes, and automated compliance alerts
- Standardized 100+ contracts and remediated over 50% found expired or non-compliant through a comprehensive governance audit of the sales contracting lifecycle
- Established a Commercial Governance Committee bringing together Sales, Finance, and Operations directors — creating structured oversight for resource planning, financial feasibility review, and engagement quality control

LHH

Sep 2019 – Mar 2020 | London, U.K.

Sales Operations Analyst

Managed end-to-end contract compliance and audit readiness across a national sales organization. Identified systemic governance failures that triggered a full governance overhaul and earned promotion to Operations Manager.

- Conducted governance audit of the sales contracting lifecycle, identifying critical control gaps that triggered a full governance overhaul and earned promotion to Operations Manager
- Instituted a weekly cross-functional governance review between Sales and Finance leadership, creating the first structured oversight mechanism for commercial risk management
- Increased practice revenue by 6% through governance-driven improvements to client engagement processes and program adoption controls

Northwell Health

Jun 2013 – Apr 2017 | New York, U.S.

Accounts Receivable Analyst

Managed insurance carrier claims processing within one of the nation's largest nonprofit health systems, operating within HIPAA and payer-specific regulatory frameworks across the revenue cycle.

- Supported Allscripts EHR rollout at Lenox Hill Cardiology — translating between the implementation team and practice staff, establishing revenue cycle operations for 2 major practices, and managing a portfolio of 60+ high-risk denial claims with a 65% recovery rate

EDUCATION

Western Governors University

Expected Graduation: 2027

Bachelor of Science, Information Technology

Competency-based program spanning cloud computing, cybersecurity, networking, data management, and Python automation — with built-in preparation for CompTIA Cloud+ and Security+ certifications. Coursework in IT governance, risk management, and AI foundations directly supports my focus on architecting compliant, governed AI systems.

GRC Mastery

May 2026

Cybersecurity GRC Professional Program

Comprehensive cybersecurity GRC training leading to ISO 27001 Lead Auditor certification (Exemplar Global accredited). Covers information security risk management, security audit methodology, asset management, identity and access management, data security, incident response, third-party risk management, and NIST CSF capstone project.

GoCloud Careers

Jan 2024 – Ongoing

Enterprise Architecture & Generative AI Architecture

300+ hour professional training in enterprise architecture under Michael Gibbs and generative AI architecture under David Linthicum. Covers enterprise architecture principles, AI system design, and architectural review — providing the strategic and technical foundation for governing AI systems across enterprise operations.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Portfolio project briefs, governance artifacts, and detailed write-ups available at request — covering AI governance engagements across chemical manufacturing, luxury retail, healthcare, and commercial governance.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Governance & Risk: Governance Framework Design, Risk Assessment, Controls Mapping, Audit Readiness, Compliance Management, Policy Development, Data Governance, ISO 27001, ISO 42001, NIST AI RMF, NIST CSF, EU AI Act

GRC Engineering & Cloud: Compliance as Code, Policy-as-Code (OPA/Rego), Infrastructure as Code (Terraform), CI/CD Compliance Pipelines, OSCAL, Automated Evidence Collection, AWS (S3, IAM, Lambda, CloudTrail, Config, Bedrock, Verified Permissions)

Business Analysis & Process: Enterprise Architecture, Business Capability Mapping, Requirements Elicitation, Process Models, Data Models, User Stories, Acceptance Criteria, Functional & Non-Functional Requirements, CRUD Matrix, Workflow Analysis

Platforms & Tools: AWS, Terraform, Git/GitHub Actions, Cosign, Salesforce, ServiceNow, Jira, Confluence, Copilot, Claude, Perplexity

KEY STRENGTHS

Translating complex regulatory requirements into clear, actionable controls · Exercising judgment in ambiguous, evolving regulatory environments · Building influence and driving alignment across teams without direct authority · Communicating governance concepts to technical and non-technical stakeholders · Adaptability across industries, frameworks, and organizational maturity levels

CORE COMPETENCIES

Governance Framework Design · Risk Assessment & Controls Mapping · Regulatory Compliance (AI, Privacy, InfoSec) · Controls-to-Code Translation · Evidence Architecture & Audit Readiness · Cross-Functional Stakeholder Management · Process Architecture & Optimization · Program Management · Client-Facing Consulting · Workshop Facilitation & Training · Change Management

CERTIFICATIONS

AIGP — IAPP — *Planned*

ISO/IEC 42001 Lead Auditor — *Planned*

ISO/IEC 27701 Lead Auditor — *Planned*

ISO 27001 Lead Auditor

Lean Six Sigma Green Belt

Process Improvement Specialist

SQL — Introduction & Advanced

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

IAPP (International Association of Privacy Professionals) — Member, 2026

GRC Engineering Club — Member, 2026

WiCyS (Women in CyberSecurity) — Member, 2026